

30 Days of Content

LinkedIn posts that build authority
in the DoD acquisition space

Written for Acqlerate — in the voice of a defense PM
who's been in the room

Acqlerate

acqlerate.com

How to Use This Pack

This content pack gives you 30 ready-to-post LinkedIn posts organized by theme. Each post is written in the voice of a defense acquisition PM who's been in the room—direct, experienced, no jargon. Here's how to get the most out of it.

Posting Cadence

- Post Monday / Wednesday / Friday (3x per week = 12 posts per month)
- 30 posts shown here at a daily cadence—mix, match, and schedule to your rhythm
- Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday get the highest LinkedIn engagement

Hook Strategy

- The first 2 lines carry everything—LinkedIn cuts off at “see more”
- Lead with the insight, not with “I”—the algorithm penalizes first-person openers
- Use line breaks aggressively—white space increases readability on mobile

CTAs & Hashtags

- Always end with a question OR a link to acqlerate.com
- 3–5 hashtags max, placed after the post body with a blank line separating
- Put links in the first comment, not in the post body—LinkedIn suppresses link posts

Engagement

- Reply to every comment within 2 hours of posting—signals quality to the algorithm
- Post at 7–9am or 12–1pm in your audience's timezone
- Engage with your commenters' content too—reciprocity drives visibility

What a PM actually does (vs. what people think)

POST 1

Most people think a PM's job is to keep revenue flowing in. That's the BD team's job.

A PM takes care of people. Manages the program. Protects the client relationship.

That means staffing the right talent, tracking deliverables, managing risk, communicating status—up, down, and sideways—and making sure the team has what they need to execute.

Revenue is the outcome. People are the input.

[I built a whole lesson on this at acqlerate.com — Module 06 is free to preview.](#)

#DefenseAcquisition #ProgramManagement #GovCon #Leadership

POST 2

I've seen a PM lose a \$40M recompetete because they didn't know who the COR was.

The COR writes the CPARS. CPARS follows you. You can't win the next contract if your past performance says you were invisible to oversight.

The PM treated the COR as an admin function. That was the mistake. The COR is your evaluator. Your rating. Your future business.

[Know who controls your rating. Module 03 — Defense Contracting Fundamentals.](#)

#COR #CPARS #ContractorPM #DefenseContracting

POST 3

The best contractor PMs I've worked with have one thing in common. They lead people first.

Not title-chasers. Not technical experts who got promoted. People who genuinely care about their team, their client, and the mission.

Everything else—delivery, retention, repeat business—follows from that. If you don't want to be in the business of people, don't become a PM.

[What's the best advice you got about making the PM transition?](#)

#ProgramManagement #Leadership #GovCon #DefenseContractor

DoD acquisition demystified

POST 4

Color of money isn't a metaphor. It's a legal constraint that can end careers.

Quick breakdown: O&M, RDT&E, Procurement. You can't use O&M to buy a \$400K piece of equipment. It's an ADA violation. The Antideficiency Act. Real consequences for real people.

I've watched a program office scramble in September because someone confused O&M with Procurement.

[Module 02 — Defense Finance & Budgeting covers this with zero jargon.](#)

#ColorOfMoney #DefenseBudgeting #ADA #DoDAcquisition

POST 5

The IDIQ vehicle is the hunting license. The task order is the hunt.

I watch contractors celebrate winning a vehicle for weeks. Then nothing. Because winning the seat on an OASIS+ or SEWP doesn't mean you get any work.

You still have to compete for every task order. The vehicle is the right to bid. The work is what you bid for.

[Module 03 breaks this down — IDIQ, task orders, fair opportunity. Link in bio.](#)

#IDIQ #TaskOrder #OASISPlus #GovContracting

POST 6

September 30th is not just the end of the fiscal year. It's a warning.

In the last 30 days of the fiscal year, every contracting office in DoD is drowning. Expiring O&M. Rushed requisitions. Vague SOWs. Scope that wasn't fully thought through because someone had to obligate by EOD Friday.

The projects that start in September often have the worst-defined requirements. If you're a contractor and you get a September call, ask more questions than usual.

[Understanding the fiscal calendar changes how you plan. acqlerate.com](#)

#FiscalYear #GovCon #DefenseAcquisition #ContractManagement

Contractor PM career advice

POST 7

Nobody tells you this when you become a contractor PM: the IDIQ ceiling is not your budget.

The ceiling is the maximum the government can order under the vehicle. The minimum guarantee might be \$1. You can win a 5-year, \$50M IDIQ and get \$1 of work if they don't issue task orders.

Track your vehicle utilization. Know your ordering period. Know when the vehicle expires. The clock runs whether or not work is flowing.

[IAC MACs, TDLs, and IDIQ structures — Module 03, Lesson 4.](#)

#IDIQ #ContractorPM #GovCon #DefenseContracting

POST 8

The constructive change is the most expensive mistake I see contractor PMs make.

COR asks for something not in the SOW. PM says yes to keep the relationship smooth. Six months later, they've burned 200 hours of labor that aren't billable, have no documentation, and can't file an REA because there's no written record of direction.

The right answer: "Happy to do that — let's make sure there's a mod." Three words that protect everyone.

[Module 03 — Modifications & REAs covers this in detail.](#)

#ConstructiveChange #REA #ContractAdmin #ContractorPM

POST 9

Your clearance is an asset. Treat it like one.

At the senior level in defense contracting, your clearance and your program relationships are what you're actually selling. Not your resume. Not your certifications.

A cleared GS-14 who knows the customer organization is worth more to a contractor than almost any credential. Protect it. Don't let it lapse. Don't let gaps go undisclosed. It's the foundation everything else is built on.

[Module 06 — PM Operations covers the full career roadmap.](#)

#SecurityClearance #GovCon #CareerAdvice #DefenseContractor

Leadership in acquisition

POST 10

I've never seen a failed program where the PM led well.

That's not luck. It's causation. A PM who takes care of their people creates a team that surfaces problems early. A team that surfaces problems early can actually fix them.

Programs fail when problems hide—in status reports, in silence, in optimism. Psychological safety is a risk management tool. Most PMs don't know that.

[acqlerate.com](#) — **Module 06: PM Operations & Leadership**

#Leadership #ProgramManagement #RiskManagement #DefenseAcquisition

POST 11

The best program review I ever sat in had zero green stoplight charts.

Everything was yellow or red. Every item had an owner, a mitigation plan, and a date. Nothing was hidden. Leadership knew exactly where the risks were.

The PM who ran that review got promoted. Because the instinct to color everything green to avoid hard conversations is exactly the instinct that causes programs to blow up—six months later, suddenly, with no warning.

Risk management module coming soon. In the meantime — [acqlerate.com](#)

#RiskManagement #ProgramManagement #Leadership #GovCon

POST 12

If your team is afraid to tell you bad news, that's a leadership problem. Not a team problem.

I mean this directly. The PM sets the culture. If the PM reacts badly to problems, the team stops bringing problems. If the team stops bringing problems, the PM stops seeing them.

But the problems don't stop existing. They just show up later—bigger, more expensive, and with less time to fix them. Build the culture where bad news travels fast. It's the most risk-reducing thing you can do.

What does your program review culture look like? Drop a comment.

#Leadership #TeamCulture #ProgramManagement #DefenseAcquisition

Source selection and proposals

POST 13

I read Section M before I read anything else in an RFP. Every time.

Section M is the scoring rubric. Everything else in the proposal exists to score well against it. If technical approach is weighted highest, your best writer goes there. If past performance is pass/fail, don't write 20 pages on it.

Most proposals I've reviewed spend the most effort on what the team knows best—not on what the government is actually scoring.

[Module 05 — Capture Management covers Section L vs M in depth.](#)

#SourceSelection #ProposalWriting #SectionM #GovCon

POST 14

The government doesn't evaluate proposals. People do.

Evaluators have 50 pages to read, a busy day job, and specific questions to answer. Your proposal's job is to make their job easy.

Answer the stated evaluation factors directly. Don't make them hunt for the response to a criterion. Don't be clever. Be clear. The firms that win consistently write for the evaluator, not for themselves.

[acqlerate.com — Module 05: Capture Management & BD](#)

#ProposalDevelopment #GovCon #SourceSelection #BestValue

POST 15

Showing up at industry days is market intelligence. Not schmoozing.

Industry days are where you learn the CO's priorities, the COR's pain points, and the evaluation approach they're considering—before the RFP drops.

Competitors who attend understand what the government actually wants. Competitors who don't are guessing. I've seen firms spend \$200K on a proposal and lose to a smaller company that had been showing up at industry days for 18 months.

[Start learning the government side. Module 01 is free at acqlerate.com](#)

#IndustryDays #CaptureManagement #GovCon #BusinessDevelopment

Finance & budgeting

POST 16

EVM is not a reporting requirement. It's a management tool. Most programs treat it like paperwork.

Earned Value Management tells you—right now—whether your program will finish on time and on budget. The math works. CPI below 1.0 means you're spending more than you're earning. SPI below 1.0 means you're behind schedule.

But most program offices generate the reports and never use the information. That's not oversight. That's compliance theater.

[Module 04 — Data Analytics for PMs covers EVM metrics in plain English.](#)

#EVM #EarnedValue #ProgramManagement #DefenseAcquisition

POST 17

The minimum guarantee on an IDIQ is not a budget. It's a legal floor.

The government is only legally required to order the minimum guarantee amount. That might be \$2,500 on a \$50M vehicle. Everything above that is discretionary.

Contractors celebrate winning vehicles. But the vehicle is only worth what gets ordered against it. Build your pipeline assumptions on realistic task order projections—not on vehicle ceilings.

[Defense Finance module — understanding what's actually funded. acqlerate.com](#)

#IDIQ #ContractFinance #GovCon #DefenseContracting

POST 18

DCAA isn't your enemy. Unclean books are.

I've worked with contractor PMs who treat a DCAA audit like a threat. Here's the thing: if your accounting system is compliant, your timecards are accurate, and you're not billing unallowable costs—a DCAA audit is just a process.

The ones who panic are the ones who haven't been keeping clean books. Cooperate. Open the door. Answer the questions. That's it.

[Module 02 — DCAA & DCMA: what they're actually looking for.](#)

#DCAA #GovConFinance #CostAccounting #DefenseContractor

Career transitions

POST 19

If you want to transition from military service into defense acquisition, here's where to start.

You already know how the programs work. You've lived the customer side. What you need is the contracting and finance vocabulary to operate on the civilian or contractor side.

USAJOBS for government. Program Analyst roles for contractors. PMP as a goal, not a prerequisite. And Module 01 on Acqlerate—it's free and covers the full landscape in plain English.

Free starting point: acqlerate.com — DoD Acquisitions Foundations

#MilitaryTransition #VeteranJobs #DefenseAcquisition #GovCon

POST 20

The gap between 'I support acquisition programs' and 'I lead acquisition programs' is exactly one thing.

Knowing why the rules exist, not just what the rules say. Anyone can learn the FAR. Anyone can take the DAU courses.

The professionals who move into leadership positions understand the intent behind the regulation—so they can navigate around it when the situation requires judgment, not just compliance. That's the difference between a technician and a leader.

That's what Acqlerate is built to teach. acqlerate.com

#CareerGrowth #Leadership #DefenseAcquisition #ProgramManagement

POST 21

The contractor PM who understands the government's acquisition process will always outperform the one who doesn't.

Not because they play the system. Because they understand what the customer is dealing with. Budget constraints. Congressional pressure. ACAT oversight. Color of money.

When you understand that context, you stop asking why the government is slow—and you start helping them move faster within their constraints. That's partnership. That's what wins recompetes.

Learn the government side. It makes you better on the contractor side. acqlerate.com

#ContractorPM #GovCon #DefenseAcquisition #CustomerFocus

Myths and misconceptions

POST 22

DAU certification and acquisition fluency are not the same thing.

DAU gets you credentialed. Acqlerate gets you competent. DAU training is compliance-oriented by design—it has to be.

But passing ACQ 101 doesn't mean you know how to run a source selection or manage a cost-type contract through a difficult performance period. The certificate is the floor. Actual fluency is what you build on top of it.

[Complement your DAU training. acqlerate.com](#)

#DAU #AcquisitionTraining #GovCon #ProfessionalDevelopment

POST 23

Winning the contract is not the hard part. Delivering it is.

The acquisition world spends enormous energy on capture and proposals. And for good reason—you have to win to play.

But I've watched firms win beautiful contracts and then struggle through execution because nobody on the delivery team knew how to manage a cost-type contract, handle a constructive change, or build a working relationship with the COR. Win smart. Deliver smarter.

[Module 03 — from contract award through modifications and closeout.](#)

#ContractManagement #GovCon #ContractorPM #DefenseAcquisition

POST 24

A PM's job is not to have all the answers. It's to make sure the right people are working the right problems.

This took me longer to learn than I'd like to admit. When you come up through a technical track, the instinct is to solve problems yourself. Fast, clean, efficient.

But as a PM, that instinct is a liability. Your job is triage and enablement. Who is best positioned to solve this? Do they have what they need? Does leadership know what they need to know? Those are the questions.

[What was the biggest mindset shift you made when you became a PM?](#)

#ProgramManagement #Leadership #GovCon #CareerAdvice

Quick practical tips

POST 25

Three things every new contractor PM should know cold on Day 1.

1. Your task order—what work is actually authorized, what the SOW says, what each CLIN funds.
2. Your subcontracts—who your subs are, what you promised them, whether they're on track.
3. Your finances—your burn rate, your ETC, whether your funded value matches your estimate.

A PM who can answer all three without looking it up has command of their program.

[Module 03 & 04 cover all of this. acqlerate.com](#)

#ContractorPM #ProgramManagement #GovCon #DefenseContracting

POST 26

Set a 90-day calendar reminder for every option on every task order you manage. Do it today.

Option exercise discipline is basic. Miss the window and you've forfeited the option—you'll need a new competition, a J&A, and a bridge contract that costs more and signals poor planning.

I've seen this happen to experienced PMs. Not because they didn't know. Because they didn't track it. The fix takes five minutes.

[Risk and contract management — Module 06.](#)

#ContractManagement #OptionExercise #GovCon #ContractorPM

POST 27

If your COR asks you to do something that isn't in your SOW — stop.

Don't do it yet. Say: 'I want to make sure we're covered—can we get a mod?' Nine times out of ten the COR didn't realize it was out of scope.

Most of the time you can get a quick mod and proceed. The tenth time, the government says they don't have funding—which tells you everything you need to know about whether you should do it.

[Modifications & REAs — the lesson every contractor PM needs. acqlerate.com](#)

#SOW #ContractMod #COR #GovCon

Acqlerate-specific

POST 28

I built Acqlerate because I kept watching smart people get lost in acquisition jargon.

Not because they weren't capable. Because nobody had explained the system to them in plain English.

DAU assumes you're already in the system. Google gives you FAR citations without context. I wanted to build something that started from first principles—what is this, why does it exist, and how do you actually use it.

That's the whole idea.

[Start with Module 01 — free. **acqlerate.com**](#)

#DefenseAcquisition #AcqlerateAcademy #GovCon #ProgramManagement

POST 29

Module 01 is free. Not as a teaser. Because I think everyone entering this field deserves a solid foundation.

DoD Acquisitions Foundations covers the lifecycle, the key players, how contracts work, how money flows, and what each career path looks like. It takes about 2 hours.

I've had people tell me it clarified things they'd been confused about for years. Start there. No credit card. No commitment.

[acqlerate.com — Start Free](#)

#FreeTraining #DefenseAcquisition #GovCon #ProgramManagement

POST 30

The room is full of people who don't know what they don't know. You don't have to be one of them.

DoD acquisition has a language. A structure. A logic. Once you understand it, the confusion disappears.

Budget cycles make sense. Contract types make sense. Why the government moves slowly makes sense. It's learnable. It just hasn't been taught well—until now.

[acqlerate.com — Built for people who want to show up prepared.](#)

#DefenseAcquisition #GovCon #Acqlerate #ShowUpPrepared

Post Formatting Tips

Quick reference for maximizing your LinkedIn reach and engagement.

Optimal Length

800–1,300 characters per post. Long enough to deliver value, short enough to hold attention.

Hook Line

First 2 lines are critical—no “I” to start (algorithm penalizes it). Lead with the insight, the tension, or the counter-intuitive truth.

Formatting

Use line breaks aggressively. White space increases readability, especially on mobile. Short paragraphs. One idea per block.

Hashtags

3–5 hashtags placed at the end after a blank line. Don’t hashtag-stuff. Use industry-specific tags your audience follows.

Timing

Post at 7–9am or 12–1pm in your audience’s timezone. Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday have the highest LinkedIn engagement.

Engagement

Reply to every comment within 2 hours of posting. This signals quality to the algorithm and keeps your post in circulation longer.

Links

Don’t put links in the post body—LinkedIn suppresses link posts in the feed. Put your URL in the first comment instead.

Consistency

The algorithm rewards consistent posting more than viral posts. Show up 3x per week. The compound effect is real.